

Experiment No: 5

Objective: Design Thinking Workshop

Overview

A **Design Thinking Workshop** is a collaborative session structured around the **Design Thinking process** to foster creativity, problem-solving, and innovation. These workshops can range from a few hours to several days, conducted in-person or remotely, depending on the context and objectives.

Key Focus Areas

1. **User Sensitivity** – Understanding real problems and building empathy for target users.
2. **Idea Generation & Problem-Solving** – Brainstorming multiple innovative solutions.
3. **Prototyping & Testing** – Developing and refining prototypes based on user feedback.

Need for Design Thinking Workshop

- Encourages **user-centric problem-solving**, leading to better products and services.
- Fosters an **innovative and collaborative culture** within organizations.
- Enhances **employee skills** in creativity and critical thinking.

- Drives **team-based innovation** through shared learning experiences.
 - Provides a **competitive advantage** by integrating user-driven insights into business strategies.
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Stages of a Design Thinking Workshop

A **Design Thinking Workshop** consists of two main phases:

1. Planning Stage

This phase ensures the workshop is well-structured and aligned with organizational goals.

- **Learning Goals** – Identify key challenges and desired outcomes.
- **Pre-Meeting** – Define workshop objectives, agenda, and participant backgrounds.
- **Checking the ambience of the workshop:**– Set up a conducive environment with proper seating and digital tools.
- **Flow of Activities** – Develop interactive exercises, case studies, and discussions.
- **Study Material for the workshop:**– Distribute relevant materials before the workshop to enhance preparation.

2. Workshop Execution Stage

This stage involves interactive learning and hands-on application of Design Thinking principles.

Introduction – Set the stage by discussing the five Design Thinking stages (Empathize, Define, Ideate, Prototype, and Test).

1. **Defining the Problem Statement** – Use **empathy mapping** to refine challenges into actionable problem statements.
2. **Idea Generation & Testing** – Apply **brainstorming, mind mapping, and visual data analysis** to explore creative solutions.
3. **Prototyping** – Participants develop **initial models** and collect peer feedback. **Journey mapping** may be used to align solutions with user needs.
4. **Testing** – Evaluate prototypes against real-world scenarios and business processes.
5. **Closing of the workshop:** – Trainers provide insights on applying Design Thinking in workplace challenges, reinforcing its long-term benefits.

Conclusion: By integrating Design Thinking workshops into corporate culture, organizations can drive **innovation, user-centricity, and sustainable growth** in a rapidly evolving business landscape.